

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Cryosurgery of Prostate

230.9

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

230.9

Manual Section Title

Cryosurgery of Prostate

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

07/01/2001

Implementation Date

07/01/2001

Description Information

Benefit Category

Inpatient Hospital Services

Outpatient Hospital Services Incident to a Physician's Service

Physicians' Services

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

Cryosurgery of the prostate gland, also known as cryosurgical ablation of the prostate (CSAP), destroys prostate tissue by applying extremely cold temperatures in order to reduce

the size of the prostate gland. It is safe and effective, as well as medically necessary and appropriate, as primary treatment for patients with clinically localized prostate cancer, Stages T1-T3.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

Cryosurgery of the prostate as a salvage therapy is not covered for any services performed prior to June 30, 2001.

Salvage Cryosurgery of Prostate After Radiation Failure. Salvage cryosurgery of the prostate for recurrent cancer is medically necessary and appropriate only for those patients with localized disease who:

1. Have failed a trial of radiation therapy as their primary treatment; and
2. Meet one of the following conditions: Stage T2B or below, Gleason score <9, PSA <8 ng/mL.

Cryosurgery as salvage therapy is therefore not covered under Medicare after failure of other therapies as the primary treatment. Cryosurgery as salvage is only covered after the failure of a trial of radiation therapy, under the conditions noted above.

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 774 \(Medicare Hospital Manual\)](#) 

[TN 1835 \(Medicare Intermediary Manual\)](#) 

[TN 1710 \(Medicare Carriers Manual\)](#) 

[TN 260 \(Medicare Claims Processing Manual\)](#) 

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

140

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Transmittals/Downloads/R140CIM.pdf> 

Revision History

05/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10804](#) ) (CR12124)

03/2021 - This Change Request (CR) constitutes a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 10624](#)) (CR12124)

06/2016 - Transmittal 1665, dated May 13, 2016, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 1672 to: (1) 9631.1: Remove FISS responsibility and 1st sentence; (2) 9631.2: Remove additional procedure codes, including 0075T, 0076T; (3) 9631.4: Revise descriptor of dx L59.8; (4) 9631.6: Add deletion of dx C49.10, C65.9, remove deletion of dx C54.9, remove deletion of invalid dx C47.90; (5) 9631.8: Remove deletion of invalid dx C51.29, replace with deletion of dx C50.029; (6) 9631.9: Add deletion of 0V504ZZ, 0V500ZZ, override capability, and contractor discretion verbiage. All other information remains the same. ([TN 1672](#)) (CR9631)

05/2016 - This change request (CR) is the 7th maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to national coverage determinations (NCDs). The majority of the NCDs included are a result of feedback received from previous ICD-10 NCD CR7818, CR8109, CR8197, CR8691, CR9087, CR9252, and CR9540. Some are the result of revisions required to other NCD-related CRs released separately. Edits to ICD-10 and other coding updates specific to NCDs will be included in subsequent, quarterly releases as needed. No policy-related changes are included with these updates. Any policy-related changes to NCDs continue to be implemented via the current, long-standing NCD process. ([TN 1665](#)) (CR9631)

09/2012 - CMS translated the information for this policy from ICD-9-CM/PCS to ICD-10-CM/PCS according to HIPAA standard medical data code set requirements and updated any necessary and related coding infrastructure. These updates do not expand, restrict, or alter existing coverage policy. Implementation date: 01/07/2013 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1122](#)) (CR 7818)

06/2001 - Expanded coverage for those patients who failed a trial of radiation treatment and met one of the limitations set forth in policy. Effective and implementation dates 07/01/2001. ([TN 140](#)) (1632)

04/1999 - Allowed coverage only for primary treatment for patients with clinically localized prostate cancer, Stages T1-T3. Effective date 07/01/1999. (TN 110)

03/1997 - Provided noncoverage policy. Effective date 04/15/1997. (TN 93)

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Cryosurgery Ablation for Prostate Cancer \(CAG-00031N\)](#) 
- [Original Consideration for Cryosurgical Salvage Therapy for Recurrent Prostate Cancer \(CAG-00064N\)](#) 

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Cryosurgery of Prostate	1	07/01/2001 - N/A	You are here